

Philipp Hilbert. *Operational product manager who turns complex end-to-end processes into scalable systems.*

Positioning, nearly ten years of PM experience shipping regulated, data-heavy platforms – now applying that to ista's metering and measurement product.

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Dear ista hiring team,

Process complexity at scale is not a product problem you can solve from a whiteboard. I have learned this across three consecutive roles – a defence AI data platform, a public labour market analytics system, and a B2B InsurTech SaaS – where the recurring challenge was the same: fragmented stakeholder landscapes, under-documented end-to-end flows, and operational teams absorbing manual overhead that should have been automated years earlier. The ista posting describes exactly that situation inside the wettbewerblicher Messstellenbetrieb, and it is the kind of problem I find genuinely interesting to work on.

At Rohde & Schwarz, I mapped and re-engineered data ingestion pipelines for a multinational defence programme that spanned image, audio, and tabular modalities across multiple engineering teams and external stakeholders. The core deliverable was not a single feature but a scalable, auditable data transformation layer that different teams could build on independently. I reduced deployment time from several days to under forty minutes by introducing GitOps with ArgoCD, and I unblocked a platform-level infrastructure issue that had been open for over a year – alone, in one week – by treating operational constraints as product constraints rather than someone else's problem. That hands-on, end-to-end ownership is exactly what the ista posting calls for.

At the Federal Employment Agency, I served simultaneously as Product Manager for the Arbeitsmarktmonitor and as Deputy IT Security Officer, which meant holding process integrity and compliance obligations alongside feature delivery. I introduced Dagster for automated ETL and indicator generation, standardised CI/CD with full test coverage at build time, and migrated legacy systems to Kubernetes – all while maintaining a functioning sprint cadence with a distributed team. The KPI-tracking and Lean continuous-improvement culture the posting describes is not new to me; it was the operating mode for that engagement.

At Emil Group, I joined an InsurTech platform where sprint discipline had collapsed, a 17-person team was blocking itself, and client trust was deteriorating in a prototype-stage environment. I split the team into focused Scrum units, reintroduced velocity tracking and structured refinement, and ran weekly product workshops that turned client frustration into constructive input. Senior developer attrition dropped from near-total to a single departure over the engagement period. Recovering a team and a process under pressure is a skill the ista role will require as the Messstellenbetrieb scales.

I am a native German speaker with C2 English, an EU citizen based in Berlin, and available within four weeks of an offer. The 18-month contract framing works well for me – focused engagements with a clear delivery mandate are where I do my best work. I would welcome a conversation about the specific process challenges ista is facing today and where I could contribute most quickly.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*
